

EPISODE 6 (SESSION 1)

A Tale of a Tower

PRIMARY TEXT: Genesis 10:31–11:10

So far in this story we've seen God's greatest creation fail time and again. Honestly, it's pretty discouraging. Yet, God intervenes again to remind us of where we began—the garden. That place where we walked with God in the cool of the day and cared for the creatures and others within it. This story of the Tower of Babel calls us to trust The Story—to partner with God in putting the world back together, bringing the Kingdom to earth.

What happens when we move further east? Our true legacy, displayed for generations, is lost. We forget who we are—or were supposed to be. We become less human—less like the very good creation from the garden. Instead we begin to conquer and destroy. Turning the tools we've used to till the ground and create new, good things into weapons of destruction and shields for our own personal prosperity.

We've lost sight of the garden. We've lost sight of The Story.

We have lost sight of the garden. We have lost the plot of The Story.

So what does that mean for us? Or for the the original audience of this Text? What is this story, interrupting the list of generations that have come before, pointing us towards? What does the story of Babel (and even the life or Midrash of Nimrod) reveal to us about our God?

Don't stop trusting The Story. Don't try to be God. Don't try to outsmart God.

What about the do's?

Do create! But create wisely. What will you do with those things you create?

Do build! But build for a purpose that may bless others—not just yourself.

Do seek to know and learn more!

But also seek to know more about the people around you. Their loves and hates. Their beliefs and doubts. Their heritage and culture. Their language. As Marty shares, “In order for humanity to continue to progress as a whole, they will need to learn the language of others.” Not fighting an us-versus-them battle. Not dividing and conquering. Not overthrowing and monopolizing.

“In order for humanity to continue to progress as a whole, they will need to learn the language of others.”

God's intentionality shines through this story. He knew humankind had not yet learned how to work for the good of others—but they'd become quite adept at working for the good of self. God doesn't curse or destroy humanity, He scatters and even *creates* barriers that require humans to finally understand how to come alongside one another, reach through, and break those barriers down.

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This is now our difficult, good work in our partnership of putting the world back together. Have we learned the lesson? Are we ready?

God is nudging us back in the right direction. Calling us home. Returning us to where we are meant to be. Asking us to empty ourselves, and to listen to others. We need to see things from the perspectives of those who are different than us. Live differently. Celebrate differently. Mourn differently. Create differently. Speak differently.

Don't seek, like Nimrod, to be God or greater than God, building towers.

Seek to be more *like* God, creating space to see all those different than you through His eyes.

PRAYER

God,
*There are moments when I am drawn east—
Further away from the plot of The Story,
and what you've called me to do in the Kingdom.
Scatter my pride and worries.
So I may learn, again, to rest and to stop.
Knock down the towers and walls I've built to protect myself,
so we can work to build a longer table for us all.
Where we can listen and laugh and learn from each other.*

*I am your partner in putting the world back together—.
Forgive me, God, when I forget.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 6

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What piece of Genesis 11 could you meditate over and memorize this week? What could you carry with you as reminder? (Check out our YouVersion Reading Plans to help guide you.)



COMMUNITY

What relationships do you have that are evidence of God's diversity of creation? Does everyone you share community with look, speak, act, believe, etc. like you? What might you be able to do to hear different voices?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from hearing or being reminded of this message of listening to voices different than our own? Or what about knocking down towers to see others? How do you model this with your actions, what you study, or who sits at your table?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About Nimrod the mighty warrior or the treasure of "scattering" across the earth? Fears? Remember, questions are good! Questions were/are the point. Try to wrestle with this in community!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*True success is developing intimacy with God, and **recognizing what God may be trying to teach you can help you create this space.** Where and when are you spending sacred time with God? What spaces do you have, or could you create, for God to enter into deeper relationship with you (possibly through the perspectives of others? Is this sacred devotional time, service, small groups, prayer, other spiritual disciplines?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world, yet so many of them have seen more empires built than barriers torn down. **How can you show them that God is inviting EVERYONE into His Kingdom, and it is a beautifully diverse, garden-like image?** An Impact team in Utah offers weekly Conversational English classes to International Students—putting their words into action.*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Do you see those at your “work” in the goodness God sees them in or as the “other” to fear or that aren’t quite as “good” as others? Do we seek power in our workplace or are we reaching across barriers to learn from and work with those across the table? The way we manage employees and interact with customers or coworkers or families says a lot about the God we believe in and what that God believes about humanity. **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters—and so does how we seek to bring the Kingdom through understanding, not power.***